

IEEE History

IEEE is the world's largest technical professional organization. Our story touches every facet of engineering and technology.

IEEE's roots reach back to the 19th century. Scientists and engineers had harnessed electrical power; connected the world via transatlantic telegraph; and built ringing telephones and lights with switches. Electricity was gaining global influence. In the spring of 1884, a group of industry professionals met in New York, USA. They agreed on a goal: They would use their knowledge and influence to benefit humanity.

The Meaning of IEEE

IEEE—pronounced 'eye-triple-E'—is the Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers. It formed in 1963, when the American Institute of Electrical Engineers (AIEE) merged with the Institute of Radio Engineers (IRE). IEEE's members are engineers and technologists from around the world.



A Journey of Innovation

1884: A Technical Society Formed

The American Institute of Electrical Engineers (AIEE) met in October in Philadelphia, PA, USA. Western Union's president, Norvin Green, was the Institute's first president, representing the telegraph industry. Charter member Thomas Alva Edison, of the lighting industry, served as a vice president.



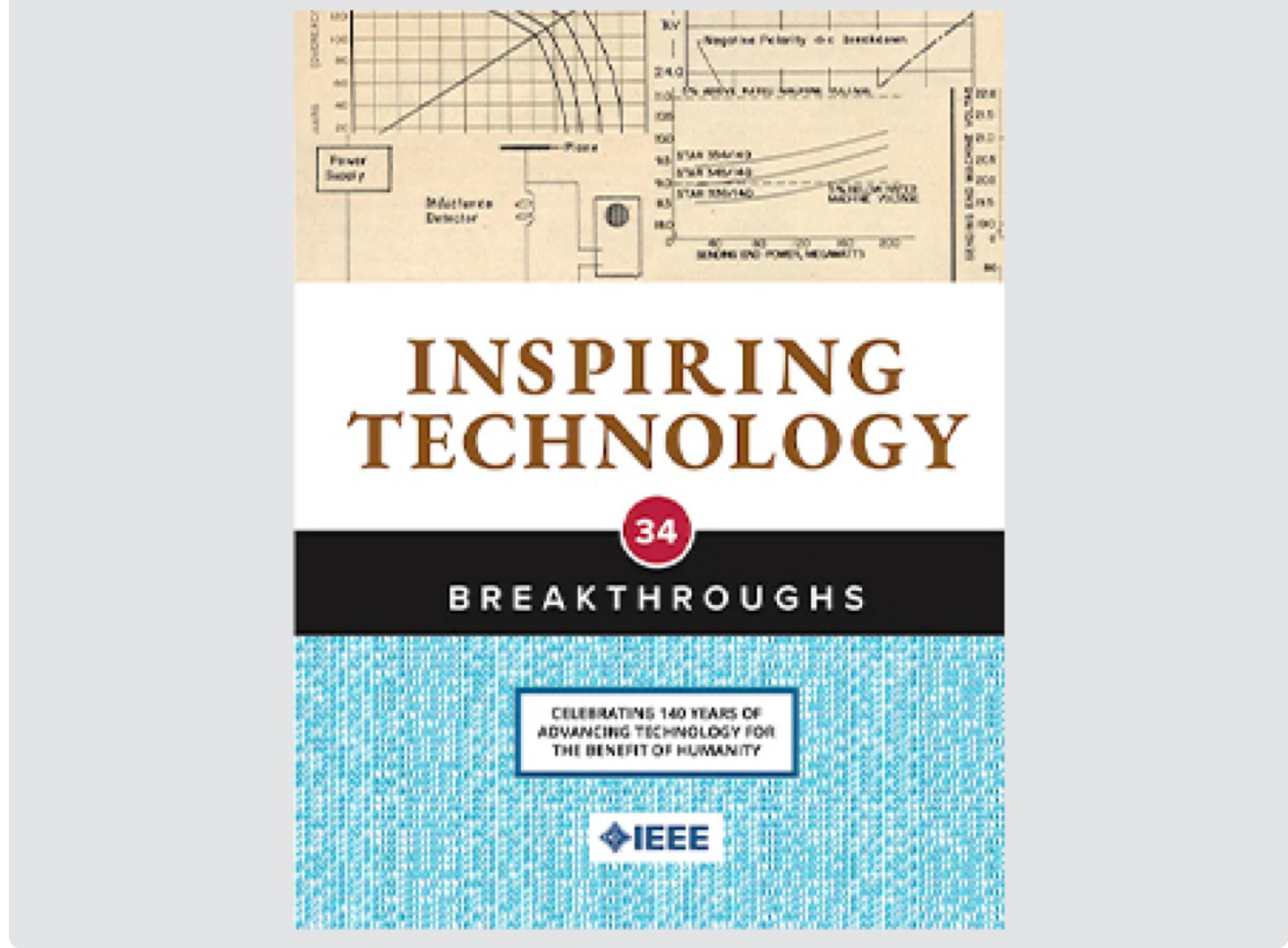
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CELEBRATING DISCOVERY

'Inspiring Technology: 34 Breakthroughs' Reveals the Minds of Innovation

Learn the unknown details behind nearly two centuries of groundbreaking inventions—including 23 IEEE Milestones—in this 140th-anniversary eBook.

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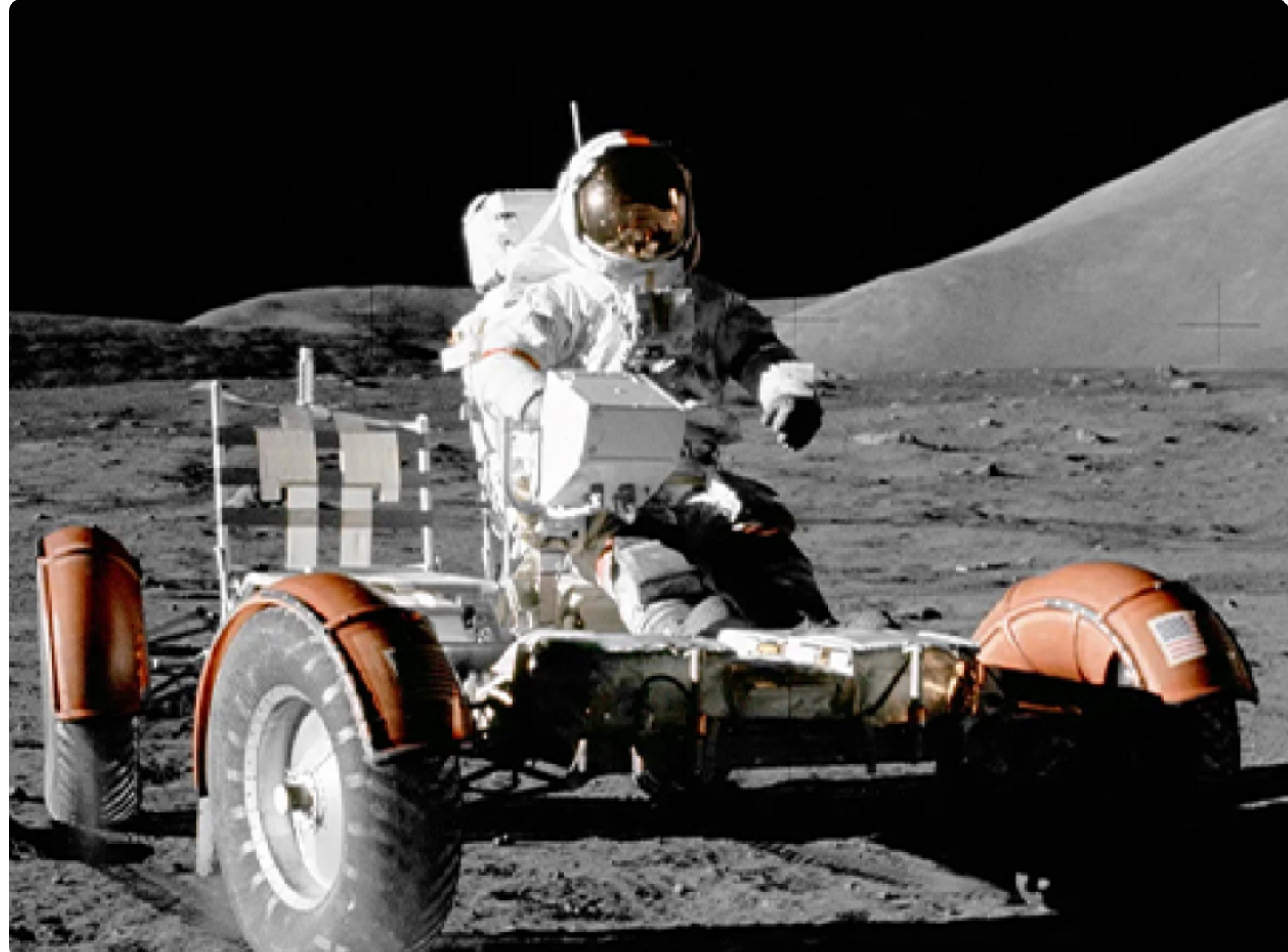


HISTORICAL ARCHIVES

IEEE History Center: Preserving and Promoting the Legacy of Engineering and Technology

Delve into the past of an organization built by engineers and technologists. Explore this collection of articles, memorabilia, milestones, and more.

EXPLORE THE ARCHIVE



Icons and Newsmakers

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COMPUTING
Coder Jean Sammett Helped Write Computer Language Cobol
15 Dec 2024 — THE INSTITUTE



SPACE
Life Member Rufus Chavez Guided an Astronaut and an Aerospace Scientist
11 Mar 2019 — THE INSTITUTE



ROBOTICS
Robot Wrangler Ayanna Howard Took Inspiration from The Bionic Woman on TV
01 Feb 2005 — THE INSTITUTE

Advance Technology. Join IEEE.

IEEE's 486,000 members are electrical and computer engineers, scientists, and technologists working together to move technology forward for the benefit of humanity.

JOIN IEEE

Explore More

IEEE is a global technical professional organization with members in more than 190 countries, pursuing innovation through our networks and benefits.

- > IEEE at a Glance
- > Building a Better World
- > Membership Benefits

ABOUT IEEE

IEEE at a Glance
History
Strategic Plan
Expanding Collaboration & Engagement Opportunities

Organizational Structure
Organizational Ethics
Financials & Statistics

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